

Sales Performance Dashboard

A Business Analysis Case Study

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Project Overview

This project involved designing a sales performance dashboard to give leadership a clear, single-page view of how the business is performing across products, regions, categories, and time. The goal was to translate raw sales data into an executive dashboard answering the nine most important business questions about revenue drivers, underperformance, and growth opportunities.

Business Objective

Leadership needed to understand not just how much the business was selling, but where the sales were coming from and where the gaps were. The dashboard was designed to answer questions such as: What is overall sales performance? Which products and regions generate the most (and least) revenue? How do sales trend across the year? How are sales distributed across categories? And what actions would increase revenue and improve consistency?

Key Performance Indicators

TOTAL SALES \$359.9M	TOTAL ORDERS 4.9K	TOTAL QUANTITY SOLD 51.2K	AVG ORDER VALUE \$73.5K
TOP REGION Western Cape – \$77.7M	TOP PRODUCT Tea – \$43.1M	TOP CATEGORY Food – 34%	

Approach & Methodology

- Data consolidation:** Consolidated order-level sales data across products, regions, categories, and months into a single analytical structure.
- Metric calculation:** Calculated total sales, order volume, quantity sold, and average order value to establish baseline performance.
- Segmentation analysis:** Broke down performance by product, region, category, and month to identify top and bottom performers in each dimension.
- Trend analysis:** Compared monthly sales to detect seasonal peaks and troughs rather than treating revenue as a flat annual figure.
- Dashboard design:** Structured the dashboard around business questions, insights, and recommendations so it reads as a decision-support tool.
- Insight-to-action mapping:** Converted every insight into a specific, actionable recommendation tied to a product, region, or time period.

Key Insights

- Strong overall performance:** The business generated \$359.9M in sales from 4.9K orders and 51.2K units sold, with a high average order value of \$73.5K, indicating high-value transactions.
- Top and bottom products:** Tea (\$43.1M) and Desk (\$42.7M) are the top-performing products, while Printer (\$37.3M) and Tablet (\$37.6M) have the lowest sales.

- **Regional performance:** Western Cape leads with \$77.7M in sales, followed by Gauteng (\$71.1M), while KwaZulu-Natal is the lowest at \$70.1M.
- **Monthly trend:** Sales fluctuate throughout the year, peaking in November at \$33.4M and dipping to a low of \$28.3M in July, indicating clear seasonality.
- **Category distribution:** Sales are well distributed across categories — Food (34%), Office (33%), and Electronics (32%) — with no single category dominating the business.
- **Balanced performance:** The performance gap between the highest and lowest regions and products is relatively small, showing a diversified and stable sales base.
- **Growth opportunities:** Clear opportunities exist to improve lower-performing products, regions, and months while continuing to leverage strong performers.

Recommendations

- **Replicate Western Cape's success:** Investigate the factors behind Western Cape's strong performance and apply the same best practices in other regions.
- **Improve lower-performing regions:** Focus targeted sales initiatives, promotions, and increased coverage on KwaZulu-Natal and Eastern Cape.
- **Capitalize on the November peak:** Plan inventory, staffing, and marketing campaigns in advance to maximize the annual November sales peak.
- **Address the July decline:** Investigate the causes of the July sales decline and introduce mid-year promotions, discounts, and customer engagement campaigns.
- **Strengthen lower-performing products:** Analyse why Printer, Tablet, and Laptop sales lag, and use targeted promotions, bundles, or pricing strategies to boost performance.
- **Maintain category diversification:** Continue investing across Food, Office, and Electronics while identifying high-growth products within each category.
- **Increase average order value:** Use cross-selling, upselling, and product bundles to push the average order value above the current \$73.5K.
- **Monitor and track performance:** Set monthly targets for products, regions, and categories, and track progress using KPI dashboards.

Key Takeaway

The business has a solid, diversified foundation, with \$359.9M in sales balanced across products, regions, and categories. Western Cape and the Tea and Desk product lines lead performance, while sales peak in November and dip in July. By leveraging top performers, addressing underperforming regions, products, and months, the company can drive revenue growth, expand market share, and improve overall profitability.

Tools & Skills Demonstrated

- Sales performance dashboard design and data storytelling
- Revenue, product, regional, and category-level analysis
- Seasonal trend and time-series analysis
- Data visualisation and KPI reporting
- Translating data insights into actionable sales recommendations